

Intro

This episodic statement explores the territory of concept and structure, reflecting an artist's recognition of crisis from diverse perspectives. Having lived as a minority in Iran, later as an immigrant in Russia and Germany, and through encounters with various people, the artist aims to achieve a broad, universal observation. By empathizing and putting themselves in others' shoes, the artist seeks to understand the challenges of different pathways, thereby gaining deeper meaning through alternative viewpoints. Through this process, the following question becomes recognized as a unified point to share with others.

What is the Current Crisis?

Skipping a long list of what can be defined as a crisis and picking only one topic, freedom is the most likely choice. The answer to the question 'Why?' could be because everything starts from the point where we assume a boundary for the 'individual', both in terms of hypothesis and reality.

The limitation of freedom applies to every individual, with extreme cases often related to nationality, gender, race, sex, and other factors.

Earlier, I mentioned a portion of the limitations on freedom that affect everyone. While extreme cases might not be the only target, these limitations still impact already persecuted minorities. These limitations can lead to forced persecutions that threaten the very existence of a large number of individuals.

As a result of these limitations, identity crisis has become a topic frequently used for various purposes, such as in social media, politics, philosophy, art, science, and other criteria of criticism. Dealing with identity crises as individuals not only leads to a loss of identity but also results in forgetting the conversation with oneself. In society, this mostly appears as manipulated voices and remains as a blind imitation of given labels coming from immoral and outdated sources.

Discovery and Development of the Manipulation from Scratch;

From the first instance that the human voice comes into existence, an additional instrument can be directly mounted on the larynx to manipulate the sound of speech from scratch. The exploration began with the discovery of the first version during an extended sound rehearsal session on the piano with Lydia Krifka-Dobes in Fall 2022.

I was thinking aloud when, accidentally, an electric massager made contact with my throat. The resulting sound was so interesting that we couldn't resist listening to it a second time. This experience created a need to explore the combination of the human voice and transducer speakers on the throat in multiple vocal pieces of music, and that exploration is still in progress.

Technical Approach:

In detail, when there are two sounds from two different sources with slightly different frequencies, they create a phenomenon known in physics as beats. This special kind of beating, which comes through frequency interference, explains how most birds can produce specific vibratos thanks to their unique throat and larynx anatomy. This phenomenon is also a specific vocal technique in Persian and Azeri music called Tahrir, where the singer imitates the same sound by phases of blocking the vocal cords to create a falsetto appoggiatura in different intervals before the main tone.

In this artistic approach, a vocal ensemble with four singers experienced the same phenomenon by singing while a transducer, which plays a sine wave with a slight pitch difference, made contact with their throats.

Below, you will find a detailed performance legend, complete with pictures and a prototype video.

/tous/

Performing Details:

- Although the text is in Persian, the score is written in the IPA (International Phonetic Alphabet) characters and requires accurate pronunciation.

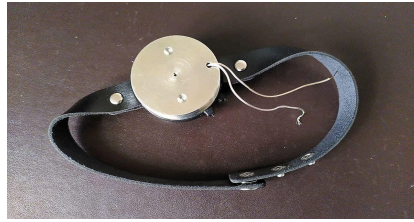
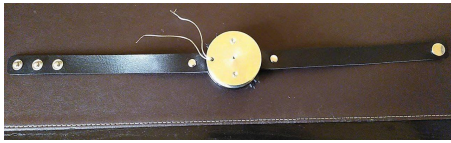
Text:

به تصویر درختی
که در حوض
زیر یخ زندانیست،
چه بگویم؟
(بیژن الهی)

/be/ /tæsvi:re/ /deræxti:/ /ke/ /dær/ /houz/ /zi:re/ /jæx/ /zendani:st/ /tʃe/ /begu:jæm/

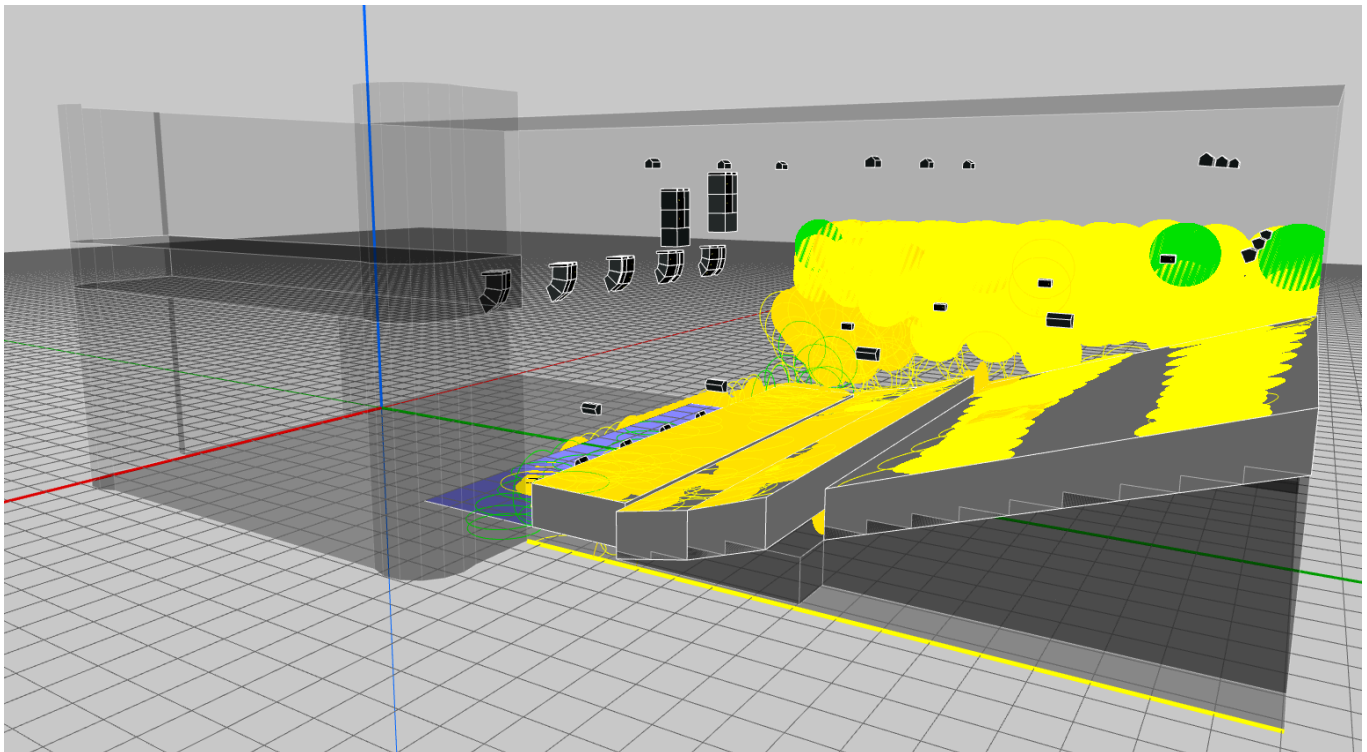
To the Tree's Image
In the Pond
Captured Beneath the Ice,
How Shall I Converse?
(Bijan Elahi, 1945 - 2010)

- In the Score;
 - Symbols are accurately chosen from meaningful musical symbols and IPA characters.
 - Green lines and symbols in the score represent notes for vocalists.
 - The pink lines in the score represent sine waves produced by transducers.
- The following pictures show wearable transducers, such as a necklace, that should directly touch the bones of the throat. Therefore, a slight pitch difference (a few Hertz) will create physical beating, which resonates in the mouth of the singer.



Equipment was provided with the generous support of the Aksenov Family Foundation for the NOMADISM project at The VOICES Performing Arts Festival on November 16, 2024, at RadialSystem Berlin, and premiered by PHØNIX16.

- Singers will be guided and tuned using a click track, alongside a 2-seconds crescendo at the starting frequency.
- Possibly, a Half-Dom ambisonic system is required to play the electronic part, as shown in the picture.



The picture above shows the venue, equipped by L-ACOUSTICS using L-ISA software for the spatialization.

- There is an abstract choreography for one dancer, who should move from one side of the stage and disappear on the other side. Three different levels of speed will be applied to the dancer's movements:
 - Fastest Movement: This should be performed by moving the head while looking at the audience and then looking away from them.
 - Medium Speed: This will be executed through the legs, incorporating backward movement.
 - Slow Movement: This should involve the hands, which start wide and open, culminating in a hug of the performer with him/herself.

- To provide a clearer understanding of the performance and introduce composition techniques involving transducers, a **Video** has been uploaded.
 - 00:00 - 01:40 Mark a prototype for demonstration of voice manipulation with transducers,
 - 01:46 - 01:58 Mark A short example how it sounded in performance,
 - 02:04 - 02:36 Mark a short example of a dancer's performance,
 - 02:42 - till the end a short example to show what the performance looked like.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7ryFdsOOtSc>

- Following is the text (TEXNO) that should be read from the 4:22 mark to the 6:53 mark of the piece;

Entity is a portion of every potential input & output,
where each portion equals one,
and it could be something or a Ding*.

All the inputs that are given to one as a chain of forces,
through which no-one is able to make any choice at the beginning,
therefore these inputs that are given to a Ding at the beginning,
and it remains the same until the end is considered as one's identity.

Although each output is related to one or more inputs in the past,
no-one remains exactly the same as the beginning,
therefore there is a reason for this question to be asked:

Is there any territory in one's entity dedicated to a Ding that is Not-Identity?

How are the meanings given in the last minute being processed?

At the same territory as a given question is being asked,
there is a questioner's mind that is a portion of an entity
but it is not identity

and also Es** is neither follower nor influencer of the identity,
so Es is neuter and deep in the Ding's subconsciousness.

Through its communication with identity an answer to a need been created,
which is sharing with sounds in order to communicate with oneself,
whether one with a Ding as itself or with any others.

Also Es as a Ding,
which is being shared in communication with the identity, is learnable.

So, Es is knowledge given to one.

Since it doesn't remain the same from the beginning until the end,
and it comes through conversation

so it's not an identity

not even entity

but it's been assumed by both

as it was conversed with the identity

by the one's Eentity***.

Samir TimajChi

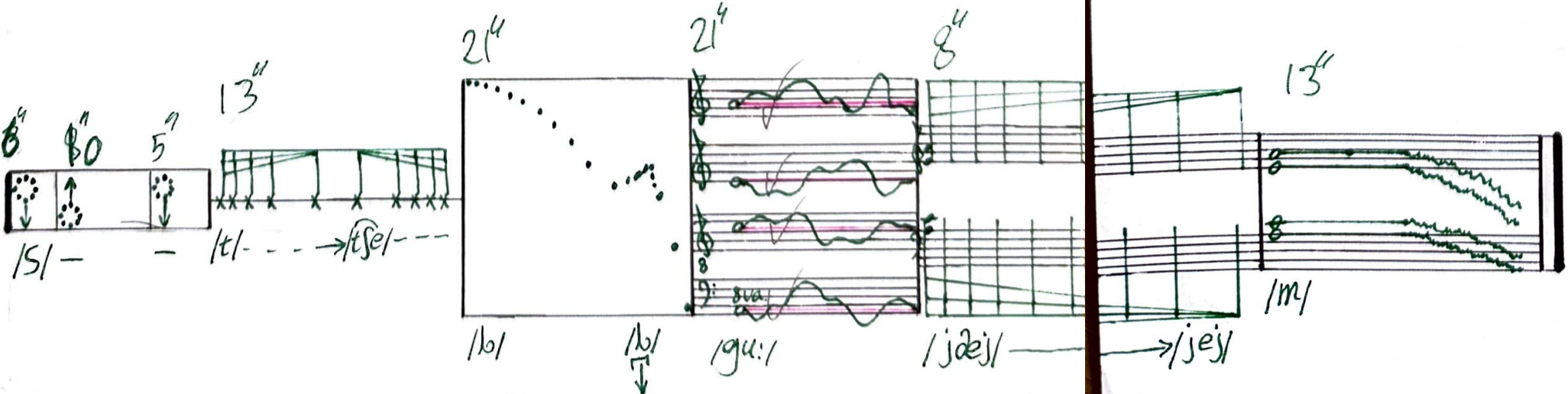
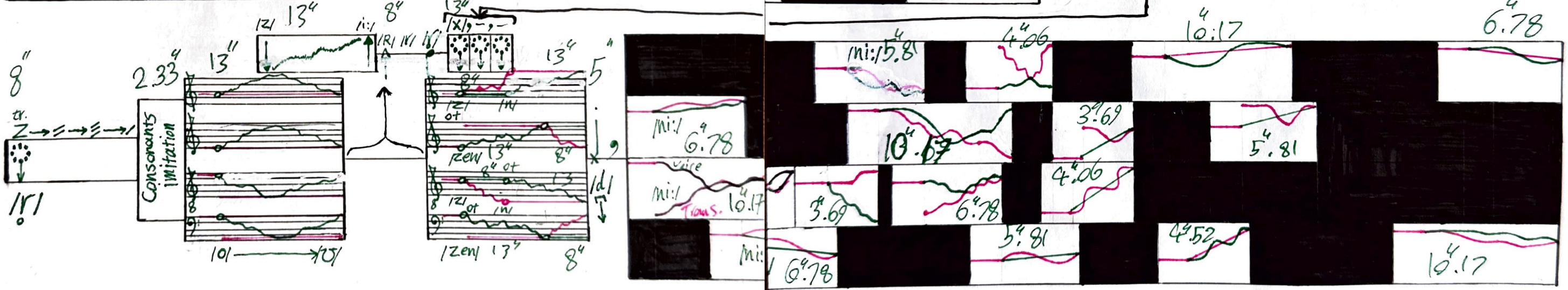
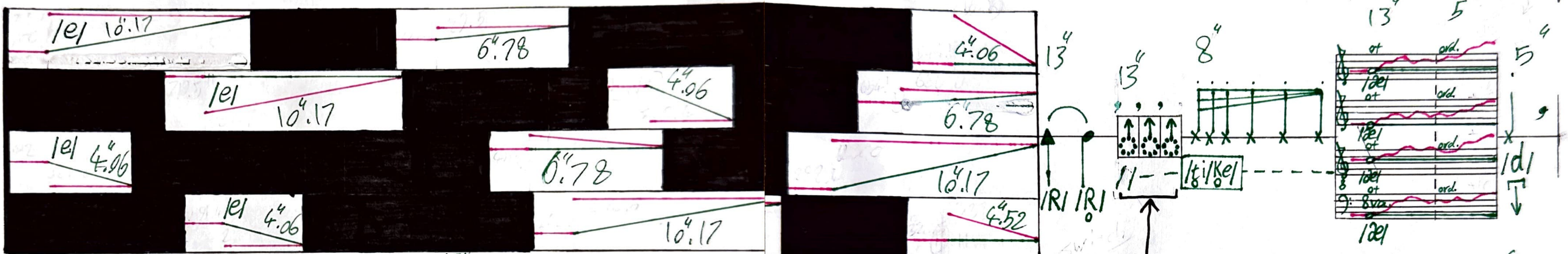
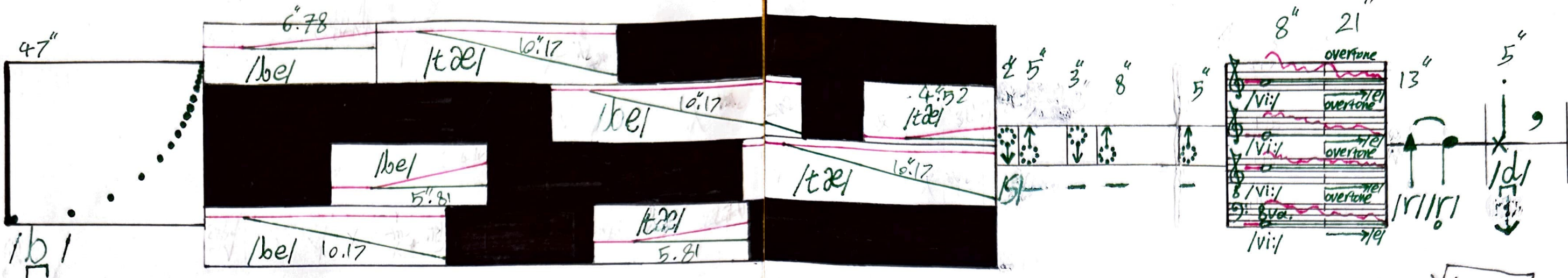
Nov. 2024

* "Ding" in German can be translated as "thing" in English, but philosophically, "Ding" refers to a being that is independent of its function.

** "Es" in German can be translated as "it" in English

*** "Eentity" : "Itentity"

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Nov. 2024